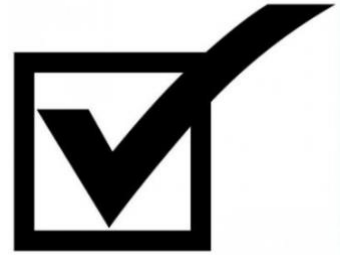


**BUSINESS
PROFESSIONALS
of AMERICA**
Giving Purpose to Potential



ETHICS & PROFESSIONALISM

(540)

STATE 2022

PRELIMINARY

Presentation Points _____ (140 points)

Specification Points _____ (20 points)

TOTAL POINTS _____ (160 points)

Preparation Time: 20 minutes

Description

Explore the application of ethical frameworks to various aspects used in business today.

State Preliminary Key Scenario

Tina works for the maker of a high-end computer drive that is favored by many industry manufacturers. Two weeks ago, one of their high volume, but also high maintenance, customers placed a large order with Digital Solutions for these computer drives. Tina promised a two-week delivery when the order was placed, as that is the date she was provided by the Manufacturing Department. The customer called today to confirm the drives would be delivered on time, as he would have to shut down his assembly line if they were late. Based on recent shortages in the current supply chain, Tina estimates there is a 50/50 chance the drives will now be late. Recognizing the importance of meeting this delivery deadline, she is considering whether or not to share the strong possibility of a late delivery with the customer. She is concerned he may cancel the current order and possibly even switch to another company for future orders.

- How should Tina proceed?
- What company ethics policies may be violated based on her decision?
- How will Digital Solutions' reputation and future relationship with the customer be impacted based on her decision?

A contestant will be DISQUALIFIED for violations of the Copyright and Fair Use Guidelines.

Contestants who do not submit an entry that follows this topic will be disqualified.

Answers will vary, but may include the following from the *Ethics and Professionalism*

Resources Manual:

- Professionalism allows for heightened respect from clients, thereby, opening greater lines of communication and potentially increased trust. A company known for maintaining a level of high ethical and professional standards is typically valued above its peers when competing in the same market.
- Strong leaders exhibit appropriate professional communication skills.
- A person's ethics in their personal life will undoubtedly affect how they conduct business.
- Good business practice requires trust. Neither you nor your business can succeed with a reputation for untrustworthiness.
- Integrity is generally the term that is most associated with business ethics and is the foundation on which good commerce is built.
- Good business ethics requires that ethical behavior be practiced both internally as well as outside of the business.
- Paying respect to co-workers, oneself and clients, being honest during any type of transaction, and taking responsibility for one's own actions is both ethical and professional.
- Today's employees are looking for a workplace that exhibits positive ethical and professional values.